LARKSPUR LANE VETERINARY CLINIC

SOP: Daily Inbox and Calendar Management

AI-ASSISTED SAMPLE

Prepared by Jennevie Javier · Version 1.0 · Fictional client

Purpose	Make sure every client email gets the right answer, from the right person, on time, and that the appointment calendar is always accurate.
Who does this	Virtual assistant (remote), Monday to Saturday
Tools	Gmail (clinic inbox), Google Calendar (one calendar per vet), shared Google Doc of reply templates
Response target	Every email answered or acknowledged within 4 business hours

> **Golden rule: the VA never gives medical advice.** If an email mentions any of these, call the clinic right away and tell the client to call or come in now: trouble breathing, seizures, bleeding that won't stop, possible poisoning, collapse or can't stand, heatstroke, straining with no urine.

1. Inbox labels

Label	What goes here	Who handles it
1-URGENT	Anything health-related that sounds urgent (see golden rule)	Call the clinic now
2-Appointments	Booking, rescheduling, cancelling	VA
3-Vet Questions	Non-urgent health questions, test results, medication refills	Vet on duty
4-Billing	Invoices, payment questions, insurance forms	VA first, then practice manager
5-Records	Requests to send records to another clinic, groomer or boarding	VA
6-Vendors	Suppliers, deliveries, sales emails	Practice manager
9-Done	Fully handled; archive	Anyone

2. Daily routine

Time	Task
8:00 am	Read every new email. Check for 1-URGENT first. Label everything. Answer appointment and records emails.
8:30 am	Check today's calendar: confirm every slot has a pet name, owner phone number and visit reason. Fix gaps.
12:00 pm	Second inbox sweep. Follow up on anything waiting more than 4 hours.
3:00 pm	Send reminder messages for tomorrow's appointments (template R1).
5:30 pm	Final sweep. Write the end-of-day handoff note (section 5).

3. Calendar rules

- **Colors:** green = wellness and vaccines, blue = sick visits, red = surgery, yellow = follow-ups, gray = staff blocks (lunch, meetings).
- **Event title format:** *Pet name (species) - Owner last name - Reason*, for example "Max (dog) - Wilson - Booster".
- **Lengths:** wellness 30 min, new patient 45 min, sick visit 30 min. Surgery times are set only by the vet.
- Never double-book a vet. If a client insists, offer the first open slot and add them to the waitlist.
- When a client cancels, delete the event, then check the waitlist and offer the slot within the hour.

4. Reply templates

Code	Use it for
A1	Booking confirmation (date, time, vet, what to bring)
A2	Reschedule with three time options
R1	Appointment reminder, sent the day before
V1	"I've passed your question to the vet; expect a reply by end of day"
B1	Itemized invoice explanation
C1	Records sent confirmation

Templates are a starting point. Always personalize the pet's name and the client's actual question before sending.

5. End-of-day handoff note

Posted in the team chat at 5:30 pm, using this format:

> **Inbox:** 23 handled, 2 waiting on the vet (Luna Torres test results, Rocky refill)
> **Calendar:** tomorrow 14 appointments, 1 open slot at 2:30 pm, 2 on the waitlist
> **Needs a decision:** client asking for a payment plan on a $640 bill (sent to Ana)
> **Urgent today:** none

6. Escalation

Situation	Action
Emergency signs in an email	Call the clinic immediately, then reply telling the client to call or come in now.
Angry client or complaint	Acknowledge within 1 hour, copy the practice manager, never argue.
Refund or discount request	Practice manager decides. VA acknowledges and passes it on.
Not sure which label fits	Use 3-Vet Questions. Better to ask than to guess.

AI-assisted sample by Jennevie Javier. Larkspur Lane Veterinary Clinic and its staff are fictional. The emergency list follows the AVMA's pet first aid guidance.